2026

(NEP—2020)

(4th Semester)

ENGLISH (MAJOR/MINOR)

(Writings from North-East India)

Full Marks : 75

Time : 3 hours

The figures in the margin indicate full marks for the questions.

(SECTION : A—OBJECTIVE)

(*Marks* : 10)

Tick (✓) the correct answer in the brackets provided : 1×10=10

1. _____ is a Welsh scholar who edited a collection of Khasi poetry in English and Welsh.

(a) J. Shakespear ( )

(b) Nigel Jenkins ( )

(c) F. W. Savidge ( )

(d) Soso Tham ( )

2. A syncretic culture is one

(a) that has maintained cultural purity ( )

(b) that is culturally isolated ( )

(c) that is culturally hybridized ( )

(d) that is unique ( )

3. Which of the following themes is portrayed in the poem, *A Himalayan Ballad* ?

(a) Racism ( )

(b) Separation and longing ( )

(c) Loss of identity ( )

(d) Nature and beauty ( )

4. Chandrakanta Murasingh's *O, Poor Hachukrai* primarily highlighted

(a) the social and economic oppression faced by marginalized tribal communities ( )

(b) the emotional struggles of a poor tribal youth within his family ( )

(c) the decline of traditional tribal culture due to modernization ( )

(d) the impact of natural hardships on the lives of tribal villagers ( )

5. What does the young man bring as an offering to the spirit of the mountain in *The Voice of the Mountain*?

(a) Flowers ( ) (b) Fishes ( )

(c) Fruits ( ) (d) Herbs ( )

6. The word 'Sundori' means

(a) beautiful woman or a girl ( )

(b) beloved wife ( )

(c) adored one ( )

(d) lover ( )

7. The story of *Chhingpuii* is set in _____ Mizoram.

(a) Christian ( ) (b) Post-colonial ( )

(c) Modern ( ) (d) Pre-Christian ( )

8. What item does Parasu's mother give as security for the loan?

(a) A piece of land ( )

(b) A silver necklace ( )

(c) Gold thurias ( )

(d) Diamond ring ( )

9. Kirhupfümia were known to possess

(a) poisonous powers ( )

(b) powers to turn into tigers ( )

(c) powers to charm young men ( )

(d) water spirits ( )

10. What is the significance of the 'Sleeping River' in the novel, *When the River Sleeps*?

(a) It brings prosperity to the village ( )

(b) It is believed to possess a stone with immense power ( )

(c) It is a place of fishing ( )

(d) It causes floods ( )

(SECTION : B—SHORT ANSWERS)

(*Marks* : 15)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 3×5=15

UNIT—I

1. What is a lingua franca? Briefly explain.

2. Briefly mention the importance of translation in literatures from North-East India.

UNIT—II

3. What does the phrase 'the blood of peonies' symbolize in the poem, *The Voice of the Mountain*?

4. What sort of peace is desired in *We Are Not Ready for the Hand of Peace*?

UNIT—III

5. What does the novella *Chhingpuii* reveal about the Mizo courtship traditions?

6. Why does Parasu decide to dig a well?

UNIT—IV

7. Who is Ate? What is her role in highlighting Villie's personality?

8. What are 'Tekhumiavi' in the novel, *When the River Sleeps*?

(SECTION : C—DESCRIPTIVE)

(*Marks* : 50)

Answer *five* questions, taking at least *one* from each Unit : 10×5=50

UNIT—I

1. Elaborate on how colonialism superimposed a Eurocentric concept of modernity on the literatures of the North-East region.

2. Discuss the prevalent themes found in writings from the North-East India.

UNIT—II

3. What events sparked the ethnic tension in Shillong that served as the basis for the poem, *Sundori* and how is it reflected in the poem?

4. Write a critical appreciation either on Robin S. Ngangom's *We Are Not Ready for the Hand of Peace* or Mamang Dai's *The Voice of the Mountain.*

UNIT—III

5. Describe how the story, *Chhingpuii* depicts the Mizo way of life before the advent of the Christian Missionaries.

6. Discuss how *Parasu Pator's Well* by Indira Goswami critiques caste and social injustice.

UNIT—IV

7. How does Easterine Kire's novel, *When the River Sleeps* depict Naga indigenous knowledge system? Explain in detail.

8. Comment on the supernatural elements that Villie encountered on his journey to the Sleeping River.

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